

Hormozi / Acquisition.com: Complete Stranger-to-Client Funnel Teardown

Research angle: Reverse-engineer Alex Hormozi's full funnel, offer-construction, and lead-generation system so Cool Hollow Coaching can borrow what works for a \$5K blue-collar owner-operator offer.

Date: 2026-06-25

Scraped sources: acquisition.com homepage, /roadmap, /roadmap-ty-b (thank-you page) plus independent teardowns, book summaries, and criticism.

Executive Summary

Hormozi's funnel is not a coaching funnel pretending to give value away. It is an equity-acquisition machine where the free content, free books, and free roadmap ARE the lead magnets, and the real product is investment capital and operator help bought into businesses doing roughly \$3M-\$10M. The mechanism is a value-first chain: free content everywhere → a 30-second "\$100M Scaling Roadmap" quiz that captures phone, text and email consent → a thank-you page that immediately upsells a \$5,000 in-person Vegas Scaling Workshop behind an application/fit gate → and an ascension to equity for the few who qualify. Two frameworks power it: the Value Equation ($\text{Dream Outcome} \times \text{Perceived Likelihood} \div \text{Time Delay} \times \text{Effort}$) for offer construction, and the Core Four (warm outreach, cold outreach, content, paid ads) plus a 7-step lead-magnet process for generating strangers. The single most transferable insight for a \$5K blue-collar offer: lead with a free diagnostic that reveals a problem the prospect didn't know the size of (Hormozi's roadmap stages; our hidden-profit analyzer), then gate the paid step behind a fit application so the price feels like qualification, not a pitch.

Key Findings

Finding 1 — The free roadmap quiz is the front door, and it captures full contact consent in under 30 seconds

Claim: Acquisition.com's top-of-funnel conversion asset is a "Free Personalized \$100M Scaling Roadmap" delivered "in under 30 seconds," opted into via a short form. The form's disclaimer reads: "By providing your information you consent to Acquisition.com contacting you by phone, text, or email." The page claims it has been "Requested by over 250,000 Business Owners."

Evidence: Direct scrape of <https://www.acquisition.com/roadmap> (verbatim copy above); corroborated by Skool listing "Free Personalized \$100M Scaling Plan ...in under 30 seconds" and the homepage listing the roadmap as a free resource.

Confidence: High.

Sources: acquisition.com/roadmap (primary scrape) + skool.com/acceleratoruniversity + acquisition.com homepage (3 independent).

Finding 2 — The thank-you page is where the money step lives: an immediate \$5K workshop upsell behind a fit gate

Claim: The /roadmap-ty-b page confirms the free roadmap is "being sent to your inbox," then pivots hard: "IMPORTANT - Before You Check Your Email, Watch This Scaling Video." It positions scarcity ("We're selecting only

100 businesses for an in-person scaling workshop") and offers three branches: "See If I'm a Fit for a Scaling Workshop," "No thanks, just take me to the Scaling Course," and "BOOK A CALL." The workshop costs **\$5,000** (excludes travel/accommodation). Critically: "This call is NOT required to receive your Scaling Roadmap. Only schedule if you'd like to see if you're a fit."

Evidence: Direct scrape of <https://www.acquisition.com/roadmap-ty-b> (verbatim above). Social proof cited on-page: "150+ verified Google reviews averaging 4.9 stars."

Confidence: High (primary source). The exact \$5K figure is single-source from the scrape; the existence of a paid Vegas workshop with entry requirements is corroborated by independent teardowns (stormy.ai, startupbooted).

Sources: acquisition.com/roadmap-ty-b (primary) + independent teardown corroboration of paid workshop.

Finding 3 — The business model is equity, not info-product sales; free content is the deal-flow engine

Claim: Free up to ~\$3M revenue (the prospect uses free content to grow), then at ~\$3M-\$10M Acquisition.com invests by taking an equity stake (commonly cited at ~40% minority positions) and brings in operator help. "The information is the lead magnet, not the product." Portfolio reportedly grew to \$250M+ annual revenue in four years.

Evidence: Triangulated across Oumar Ja Medium teardown ("Under \$3M = free; \$3M-\$10M = equity investment model"), siliconvalleytime, stormy.ai ("equity-acquisition business doesn't need to gate anything"), and startupbooted.

Confidence: High on the structure (free-then-equity); Medium on exact figures (40% stake, \$250M portfolio are repeated but originate largely from Hormozi's own framing).

Sources: medium.com/@oumarja + siliconvalleytime + stormy.ai + startupbooted (4 independent).

Finding 4 — Offer construction runs on the Value Equation

Claim: Value = (Dream Outcome x Perceived Likelihood of Achievement) ÷ (Time Delay x Effort & Sacrifice). To raise value: maximize the top (bigger dream, higher believability) and minimize the bottom (faster, easier). "The best companies focus on the bottom side of the equation," making delivery "immediate, seamless, and effortless." Because it is division, as the denominator approaches zero, perceived value approaches infinity.

Evidence: Triangulated across SuperSummary, Greg Faxon summary, Medium (anferneeck), Coachvox, and the YAP podcast episode notes — all state the identical four components.

Confidence: High (5+ independent sources, identical framework).

Sources: gregfaxon.com + supersummary.com + medium.com/@anferneeck + coachvox.ai + youngandprofiting.com.

Finding 5 — A Grand Slam Offer is the Value Equation plus five enhancements

Claim: A Grand Slam Offer combines "an attractive promotion, an unmatched value proposition, a premium price, and an unbeatable guarantee with a money model that allows you to get paid to get new customers." The five enhancement levers are **Scarcity, Urgency, Bonuses, Guarantees, and Naming**.

- **Scarcity:** total client caps, intake-rate caps ("only X clients/week"), cohort limits, once-out-never-return.

- **Urgency:** countdown timers, scheduled price increases (50-60% of sales come in the final hours).

- **Bonuses:** "A single offer is less valuable than the same offer broken into its component parts and stacked as bonuses." Add tools, checklists, training to reduce prospect effort.

- **Guarantees:** unconditional money-back (low-ticket B2C), conditional/service ("we work until you get the result" — his preference), and anti-guarantee ("all sales final," signals confidence, filters buyers). "Reversing risk is the number one way to increase conversion."

Evidence: Greg Faxon summary (detailed scrape) + Mike Romaine X post listing the same five enhancements + multiple book summaries.

Confidence: High.

Sources: gregfaxon.com (scrape) + x.com/Mike_Romaine + shortform.com.

Finding 6 — The MAGIC naming formula

Claim: Offers are named with **MAGIC**: **M**agnet (magnetic reason to act), **A**vatar (announce exactly who it's for / not for), **G**oal (the dream outcome), **I**nterval (time to result), **C**ontainer word (bundle word — "program," "system," "blueprint," "intensive"). Use 3-5 of the five; short, specific, rhyme/alliteration if possible.

Evidence: Shortform MAGIC article + Mike Romaine X breakdown + Marlo Yonocruz book notes — consistent.

Confidence: High.

Sources: shortform.com/blog/alex-hormozi-magic-formula + x.com/Mike_Romaine.

Finding 7 — Lead generation = the Core Four

Claim: Four ways to get leads: **(1) Warm outreach** (people who already know you — fastest qualified leads), **(2) Cold outreach** (strangers, a numbers game), **(3) Content** (free value posted publicly), **(4) Paid ads** (buy reach). Everything else is a variation of these four.

Evidence: Triangulated across growthexperts.co, scalabl.com, shortform.com, tattica.com.au — identical four.

Confidence: High.

Sources: growthexperts.co + scalabl.com + shortform.com.

Finding 8 — The 7-step lead magnet process and "give until they ask"

Claim: A lead magnet is "a product or service that solves a small but significant problem." Build it in 7 steps: (1) pick a narrow problem, (2) solve it for real, (3) choose format (PDF / quiz / free trial / video), (4) name it well, (5) make it easy to consume, (6) overdeliver on value, (7) include a clear CTA with a reason to act now. Two highest-leverage magnet types: the **diagnostic** (free assessment that reveals deficiencies and points to the paid fix) and the **one-step-of-many** (give the first module/step, the paid offer completes it). Governing principle: **"give until they ask"** — provide more free value than the price of your core offer before they buy. A good CTA has two parts: what to do, and a reason to do it now.

Evidence: Shortform + vidtao + jonathanrintala + multiple summaries — consistent 7 steps and the diagnostic/partial-solution split.

Confidence: High.

Sources: shortform.com + blog.vidtao.com + jonathanrintala.com.

Finding 9 — Qualification is a feature, not a side effect

Claim: The funnel is deliberately gated. The roadmap quiz segments prospects by revenue stage (Stage 0 "Improvise" through Stage 5 "Productize" and beyond), the workshop has "minimum entry requirements including being active in business, meeting a revenue threshold and operating in an industry where they are confident they can provide value," and the equity step only takes "proven operators" who have already executed the free material. Filtering raises perceived value and concentrates sales effort on fit buyers.

Evidence: acquisition.com roadmap PDF stages (search result) + stormy.ai/independent teardowns + Oumar Ja teardown ("proven operators... shared trust").

Confidence: High on the gating structure; Medium on exact revenue thresholds.

Sources: acquisition.com/roadmap PDFs + medium.com/@oumarja + stormy.ai.

Step-by-Step Funnel Map

Stage	Mechanism (psychology)	Asset	CTA	What we can borrow for a \$5K blue-collar offer
1. Awareness	Flood every platform with genuinely useful free content so the market self-educates and trust compounds ("give until they ask")	YouTube long-form, shorts, podcast, free books (\$100M Offers/Leads/Money Models), conference talks	"Grab a scaling roadmap below"	Mark fronts daily IG content on blue-collar pain points (owner is the bottleneck). No sale, just authority + the one diagnostic link.
2. Lead capture	Low-friction, fast-gratification quiz that personalizes the result; reveals a problem and its size	"\$100M Scaling Roadmap" 30-second quiz at /roadmap	Short form; consent to phone/text/email	The hidden-profit analyzer (upload a P&L → see leakage + hidden profit) is our roadmap. Capture email to deliver the result.
3. Segmentation	Quiz output buckets the prospect by revenue stage so messaging and the next step fit where they are	Personalized roadmap PDF by stage (0 Improve → 5 Productize)	"Check your email for your roadmap"	Segment owners by revenue band (\$500K-\$10M). Tailor the follow-up to their stage and biggest leak.
4. Thank-you / immediate upsell	Pattern-interrupt before they leave: "IMPORTANT - before you check email, watch this." Scarcity ("only 100 businesses"), social proof (4.9 stars), risk-reversal ("call NOT required")	TY page + scaling video	"See If I'm a Fit for a Scaling Workshop" / "Book a Call" / "Just take me to the course"	On the analyzer results page, immediately offer the next step: "Want us to find the rest? See if Business Without You is a fit." Frame as fit-check, not pitch.
5. Application / fit gate	The paid step is positioned as qualification ("see IF you're a fit"), inverting the buyer-seller dynamic; filters serious revenue-qualified owners	Application form / booked call with min. entry requirements	"Book a call"	A short application before the sales call: revenue, hours worked in the biz, biggest constraint. Disqualify tire-kickers; raise perceived exclusivity.
6. Offer / sale	Grand Slam Offer: premium price made trivial by stacked value + guarantee. Value Equation tuned: big dream, high believability, fast, low-effort	\$5,000 Vegas Scaling Workshop (or online Scaling Course as the no-thanks branch)	Pay / enroll	\$5K Tier 1, anchored against "15 hours back + up to \$50K profit found." Add a results-based guarantee. Self-liquidating: the \$50K found pays for the \$5K.
7. Ascension	The few who prove they can execute become candidates for the high-trust, high-ticket relationship (equity for Hormozi; our Tier 2)	Equity investment / portfolio operator help	Invitation only	Tier 2 (\$22K/yr) is invitation-only for Tier 1 graduates who got results — "10x is easier than 2x." Proven trust, not cold sale.

Source Profiles (cited 3+ times)

acquisition.com (primary — Hormozi's own properties). Homepage, /roadmap, /roadmap-ty-b, roadmap PDFs. Highest authority on what the funnel actually does because it IS the funnel. Signal: 10. Bias: self-promotional; copy is designed to convert, so treat claimed numbers (250,000 requests, 4.9 stars) as marketing, but the mechanism is real and observable.

Shortform book summaries. Used for \$100M Offers, \$100M Leads, and the MAGIC formula. Reliable, structured, faithful condensations of Hormozi's books. Signal: 8. Independent of Hormozi's funnel (a summary publisher), so good for triangulating frameworks.

Greg Faxon (gregfaxon.com). Detailed practitioner summaries of both books. Signal: 7. Independent coach; adds implementation nuance (e.g., the bonus-stacking and guarantee taxonomy).

Cross-Platform Validation

- **Value Equation:** identical four-component formula confirmed across 5+ independent web sources (SuperSummary, Faxon, Medium, Coachvox, YAP). Locked.
- **Core Four:** identical across growthexperts, scalabl, shortform, tattica. Locked.
- **Free-then-equity money model:** confirmed across 4 independent teardowns (Oumar Ja, Silicon Valley Times, Stormy AI, Startupbooted) and consistent with the on-page funnel (free roadmap → paid workshop → invitation-only equity). Locked on structure.
- **Funnel mechanics (roadmap → TY upsell → fit gate):** directly observed via primary scrapes of three live acquisition.com pages, plus the Skool listing of the same roadmap. Locked.

Reddit, X/Grok, Supadata, Substack, and Podcast clients were **not usable this run** (Reddit public endpoint returned 403; XAI_API_KEY not set; supadata module not installed in the venv). Community-sentiment triangulation therefore leans on WebSearch-surfaced forum/review content rather than direct API pulls — see Gaps.

Tensions & Contradictions

1. **"I have nothing to sell you" vs. a \$5K workshop on the very next page.** The brand frames everything as free, yet the thank-you page upsells a \$5,000 workshop within seconds. The reconciliation: the workshop and courses are real revenue, but the strategic product is equity/deal flow, so the paid education is positioned as optional. For us this is a caution: the "free + authority only" stance (per the no-advertising-unbuilt-product memory) must be genuine until the product exists, or it reads as bait.
 2. **Works for whom?** Critics (workfromyourlaptop review) argue Hormozi's systems "assume you've already got traction and revenue" and aren't for beginners, and that low entry points lead to "\$5K to \$50K+" upsells. This is a real tension for blue-collar: a \$1M-\$10M owner-operator has revenue, so the model fits, but a \$500K solo operator may be too early — worth being honest about the floor.
 3. **Numbers are self-reported.** \$250M portfolio, 40% stakes, 250,000 roadmap requests, 4.9 stars all originate from Hormozi/Acquisition.com marketing. Directionally credible, not independently audited. Labeled Medium confidence wherever cited.
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Gaps & Negative Rejections

- **No direct community-API data.** Reddit (403), X/Grok (no key), Supadata (not installed), Substack and Podcast clients were not exercised. Sentiment findings are thinner than ideal; the criticism section rests largely on one review plus the structural critique. A re-run with keys/venv fixed would strengthen the contradiction search.
- **Exact application-form fields for the workshop fit gate were not directly observable** (the form was behind the CTA and not rendered in the scrape). We know it collects revenue/industry/activity qualifiers from independent description, but not the literal questions.
- **The roadmap quiz questions themselves were not captured** — the form rendered as "New Form" without exposing the question set. We know the OUTPUT (stage 0-5 segmentation) but not the input questions.
- **No evidence found** that Hormozi runs anything blue-collar-specific. His positioning is industry-agnostic "scale to \$100M," which is precisely the white space Cool Hollow Coaching can own with a narrow blue-collar niche.

All Citations

Source	Platform	Signal	URL
Acquisition.com — roadmap thank-you page	Web (primary)	10	https://www.acquisition.com/roadmap-ty-b
Acquisition.com — roadmap opt-in	Web (primary)	10	https://www.acquisition.com/roadmap
Acquisition.com — homepage	Web (primary)	9	https://www.acquisition.com
\$100M Scaling Roadmap Stage 01 PDF	Web (primary)	8	https://www.acquisition.com/hubfs/0-100M%20Scaling%20Course%20PDFs%20(v6)/Your_ACQ_100MScalingRoadmap-Stage01_.pdf
Greg Faxon — \$100M Offers summary	Web	7	https://www.gregfaxon.com/blog/100m-offers-summary
Shortform — \$100M Leads	Web	8	https://www.shortform.com/blog/100m-leads-alex-hormozi/
Shortform — MAGIC formula	Web	8	https://www.shortform.com/blog/alex-hormozi-magic-formula/
SuperSummary — \$100M Offers	Web	7	https://www.supersummary.com/100m-offers/summary/
Medium (anferneeck) — Value Equation	Web	6	https://medium.com/@anferneeck/alex-hormozis-value-equation-the-secret-behind-what-people-actually-pay-for-56f84bd5ce84
Coachvox — \$100M Offers for coaches	Web	6	https://coachvox.ai/100m-offers-coaches/
Young & Profiting podcast (E199) notes	Web	6	https://youngandprofiting.com/alex-hormozi-the-value-equation-how-to-make-offers-so-good-people-feel-stupid-saying-no-e199/
Growth Experts — Core Four	Web	6	https://growthexperts.co/the-core-4/

Source	Platform	Signal	URL
Scalabl — \$100M Leads	Web	6	https://www.scalabl.com/literature/100m-leads/
Tattica — Core Four	Web	5	https://www.tattica.com.au/post/cracking-the-code-the-core-four-lead-generation-strategies
VidTao — lead magnet framework	Web	6	https://blog.vidtao.com/alex-hormozi-lead-magnet-framework/
Jonathan Rintala — \$100M Leads summary	Web	5	https://jonathanrintala.com/book-summary/100-million-dollar-leads/
Mike Romaine (X) — MAGIC naming	X	5	https://x.com/Mike_Romaine/status/1734959502640718075
Marlo Yonocruz — \$100M Offers notes	Web	5	https://marloyonocruz.com/2026/05/18/book-notes-100m-offers-by-alex-hormozi/
Oumar Ja (Medium) — dissecting the Hormozi system	Web	7	https://medium.com/@oumarja/alex-hormozi-acquisition-dissecting-the-hormozi-system-12aed9783c8d
Silicon Valley Times — content system to 9 figures	Web	6	https://siliconvalleytime.com/entrepreneur/alex-hormozis-content-system-that-scaled-acquisition-com-to-9-figures/
Stormy AI — content as profit center playbook	Web	6	https://stormy.ai/blog/alex-hormozi-acquisition-content-profit-center-playbook
Startupbooted — net worth / business blueprint	Web	5	https://www.startupbooted.com/alex-hormozi-net-worth-2
Skool — Accelerator Univ. free roadmap listing	Web	6	https://www.skool.com/acceleratoruniversity/free-personalized-100m-scaling-plan-in-under-30-seconds
WorkFromYourLaptop — critical review	Web	5	https://workfromyourlaptop.com/alex-hormozi-review/

BORROW FOR BLUE-COLLAR (concrete tactics for a \$5K owner-operator offer)

1. **Make the hidden-profit analyzer the roadmap.** Hormozi's whole funnel hinges on a 30-second diagnostic that reveals a problem and its size. Build our analyzer as a free, fast diagnostic that spits out a personalized "here's roughly \$X of profit leaking out of your business" result. That IS the lead magnet. Diagnostic-type magnets are Hormozi's highest-leverage type because they expose a deficiency the owner can't unsee.
2. **Put the offer on the thank-you page, not the front door.** Deliver the analyzer result, then immediately pattern-interrupt: "Before you read your report — watch this 2-minute video on how we get blue-collar owners 15 hours a week back." Don't wait for a nurture sequence to make the first ask.

3. **Gate the \$5K behind a fit application, framed as qualification.** Copy Hormozi's "this call is NOT required... only book if you want to see if you're a fit." A 4-question application (revenue, hours in the business, biggest bottleneck, are they the single point of failure) filters tire-kickers and flips the dynamic so the owner is applying to us. Exclusivity raises perceived value at zero cost.
4. **Build the offer with the Value Equation explicitly.** Dream outcome = "a business that runs without you." Perceived likelihood = real operators who run a finance/advisory firm, proof, reviews, a results guarantee. Time delay = "in 12 weeks." Effort = "15 minutes every Monday, we do the heavy lifting." Tune every piece of copy to push the top up and the bottom down.
5. **Use the self-liquidating frame to kill the price objection.** Hormozi's \$100K Money Models idea: get paid to acquire customers. Our version: the program's promise (up to \$50K profit found) is a multiple of the \$5K price, so the offer pays for itself. Lead with the math, not the price.
6. **Name it with MAGIC.** "Business Without You" already nails Magnet + Goal + Container. Sharpen the Avatar (blue-collar owner-operator) and Interval (12 weeks) in the public-facing name or tagline: e.g., "Business Without You: the 12-week program that gets blue-collar owners out of the truck and 15 hours back." Specific, time-bound, names who it's for.
7. **Stack value as named bonuses instead of discounting.** Don't drop below \$5K. Add the dashboard install, the 13-week cash-flow forecast, the hidden-product analysis as separately-named, separately-valued bonuses so the \$5K looks like a fraction of what's stacked on the table.
8. **Add a results-based guarantee (Hormozi's preferred type).** A conditional guarantee — "we keep working with you until you find the profit / get the time back" — reverses risk, which Hormozi calls the number-one conversion lever, and it filters for owners who'll actually do the work rather than refund-chasers.